

C180

Introduction to Psychology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A researcher surveys 2,000 adults in five cities and finds that people who drink more coffee report higher job satisfaction. The survey took 15 minutes and was offered in two languages. Which conclusion is supported?

- A. Drinking coffee causes higher job satisfaction.
- B. Coffee drinking and job satisfaction are related, but the study cannot show that one causes the other.
- C. Higher job satisfaction causes people to drink more coffee.
- D. Nothing can be concluded because surveys are never valid.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A psychologist wants to show that a new study technique causes better test scores. Which design allows that conclusion?

- A. Randomly assign students to the new technique or the usual method, then compare scores.
- B. Compare two classes the teacher picked, without random assignment.
- C. Survey students about which technique they use and compare their scores.
- D. Study one top student in depth.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

In a sleep lab at a state university, 60 volunteers are randomly assigned to sleep either 4 hours or 8 hours. The next morning each takes a memory test. Volunteers are paid \$25 and are between 18 and 30. What is the dependent variable?

- A. The \$25 payment.
- B. Participants' ages.
- C. Hours of sleep.
- D. Memory test score.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A study finds that changing the noise level in a room changed how many errors workers made. What is the independent variable?

- A.** Both, since they are related.
- B.** Noise level.
- C.** Number of errors.
- D.** The workers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A 4-year-old at a busy preschool watches juice poured from a short, wide glass into a tall, thin glass and insists the tall glass has more. Her older brother is 9 and plays soccer. Which stage and missing ability explain her answer?

- A.** Preoperational; she lacks conservation.
- B.** Concrete operational; she lacks abstract reasoning.
- C.** Formal operational; she lacks hypothetical thinking.
- D.** Sensorimotor; she lacks object permanence.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

After a car accident on a rainy highway, a 45-year-old teacher remembers his childhood clearly but cannot form new long-term memories of people he meets. His vision and balance are normal. Which structure was most likely damaged?

- A.** Cerebellum.
- B.** Amygdala.
- C.** Hippocampus.
- D.** Occipital lobe.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A software tester with a long commute has a car that beeps loudly until she buckles her seat belt. Over time she buckles up right away. She listens to podcasts while driving. What is the beeping an example of?

- A. Positive reinforcement.
- B. Negative reinforcement.
- C. Punishment.
- D. Classical conditioning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

To reduce a child's habit of leaving toys out, a parent takes away 15 minutes of screen time each time it happens. What is this?

- A. Extinction.
- B. Negative reinforcement.
- C. Negative punishment.
- D. Positive punishment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

9.

A graphic designer who lives in a large apartment building spends about 15 minutes each morning arranging her desk just so. She enjoys the routine, and her work and relationships are thriving. Her neighbor finds it odd. Does this behavior alone meet the usual criteria for a psychological disorder?

- A. No; there is no significant distress or impairment.
- B. Yes; any repeated routine is OCD.
- C. Yes, because her neighbor finds it odd.
- D. Yes, because the behavior is unusual.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

10.

A hiring manager at a 900-person insurance firm describes an applicant as organized, dependable, and careful to meet deadlines. The applicant enjoys hiking and is left-handed. Which Big Five trait fits best?

- A.** A four-letter type such as a “judging” type.
- B.** Agreeableness.
- C.** Openness, since outdoor hobbies show curiosity.
- D.** Conscientiousness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A client at a community counseling center that offers evening hours says, “I failed one quiz, so I’m a total failure.” The counselor helps him spot the thought, test the evidence for it, and replace it with a more accurate one. The client drives 20 minutes to sessions. Which approach is this?

- A.** Psychodynamic therapy.
- B.** Pure behavioral therapy.
- C.** Cognitive-behavioral therapy.
- D.** Humanistic, person-centered therapy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A therapist offers empathy and unconditional positive regard and lets the client lead each session. Which approach is this?

- A.** Cognitive-behavioral therapy.
- B.** Psychodynamic therapy.
- C.** Behavioral therapy, because all therapy changes behavior.
- D.** Humanistic, person-centered therapy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A researcher surveys 2,000 adults in five cities and finds that people who drink more coffee report higher job satisfaction. ~~The survey took 15 minutes and was offered in two languages.~~ Which conclusion is supported?

Target word: supported conclusion **Decides:** A survey with no assignment to conditions is correlational.

A	Confusion set	Treats a correlation as cause and effect.
B	Correct	Correlational designs cannot rule out other explanations.
C	Inverted operation	Flips the direction but still claims cause without an experiment.
D	Absolute language	Surveys can validly show relationships.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A psychologist wants to show that a new study technique causes better test scores. Which design allows that conclusion?

Target word: reverse: pick the design that supports cause **Decides:** Random assignment to conditions.

A	Correct	Random assignment balances other factors, so differences can be linked to the technique.
B	Dropped element	Drops random assignment, so group differences remain possible.
C	Confusion set	Correlational; students who choose the technique may differ in other ways.
D	Adjacent category	A case study describes one person and cannot show cause.

3. Answer D Concept 2

In a sleep lab at a state university, 60 volunteers are randomly assigned to sleep either 4 hours or 8 hours. The next morning each takes a memory test. ~~Volunteers are paid \$25 and are between 18 and 30.~~ What is the dependent variable?

Target word: DV **Decides:** The memory test is what gets measured.

A	Camouflage	Payment is the same for everyone and is not measured.
B	Confusion set	Age is a participant characteristic held in a range, not the outcome.
C	Inverted operation	Sleep is what the researcher changes, the independent variable.
D	Correct	The outcome measured after the manipulation is the DV.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A study finds that changing the noise level in a room changed how many errors workers made. What is the independent variable?

Target word: solve for the IV instead **Decides:** Noise level is what was changed.

A	Confusion set	Related variables still play different roles.
B	Correct	The factor the researcher changes is the IV.
C	Inverted operation	That is the measured outcome, the DV.
D	Adjacent category	Participants are not a variable.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A 4-year-old ~~at a busy preschool~~ watches juice poured from a short, wide glass into a tall, thin glass and insists the tall glass has more. ~~Her older brother is 9 and plays soccer.~~ Which stage and missing ability explain her answer?

Target word: stage and missing ability **Decides:** Age 4 and a conservation error.

A	Correct	Preoperational children judge amount by appearance.
B	Camouflage	Fits the 9-year-old brother, not her.
C	Confusion set	Formal operations begin around adolescence.
D	Adjacent category	Object permanence is an infant milestone, not about amounts.

6. Answer C Concept 4

After a car accident ~~on a rainy highway~~, a 45-year-old teacher remembers his childhood clearly but cannot form new long-term memories of people he meets. ~~His vision and balance are normal.~~ Which structure was most likely damaged?

Target word: damaged structure **Decides:** Cannot form new long-term memories; old ones intact.

A	Adjacent category	The cerebellum coordinates movement and balance.
B	Confusion set	The amygdala handles fear and emotional responses.
C	Correct	The hippocampus is key to forming new long-term memories.
D	Camouflage	Answers the vision detail; vision is normal.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A software tester ~~with a long commute~~ has a car that beeps loudly until she buckles her seat belt. Over time she buckles up right away. ~~She listens to podcasts while driving.~~ What is the beeping an example of?

Target word: conditioning label **Decides:** An unpleasant sound is removed when she buckles, and buckling increases.

A	Inverted operation	Positive adds something pleasant; here something unpleasant is taken away.
B	Correct	Removing an unpleasant stimulus increases the behavior.
C	Confusion set	Punishment decreases a behavior; buckling increased.
D	Adjacent category	The consequence of her action shapes it, which is operant conditioning.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

To reduce a child's habit of leaving toys out, a parent takes away 15 minutes of screen time each time it happens. What is this?

Target word: reverse: decrease by removal **Decides:** Something pleasant is removed to decrease a behavior.

A	Adjacent category	Extinction withholds the reinforcer that maintained the behavior, not an unrelated privilege.
B	Confusion set	Reinforcement increases behavior.
C	Correct	Removing something wanted to decrease a behavior.
D	Inverted operation	Positive punishment adds something unpleasant; here something is taken away.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A graphic designer ~~who lives in a large apartment building~~ spends about 15 minutes each morning arranging her desk just so. She enjoys the routine, and her work and relationships are thriving. ~~Her neighbor finds it odd.~~ Does this behavior alone meet the usual criteria for a psychological disorder?

Target word: disorder or not **Decides:** No distress and no impairment.

A	Correct	Diagnosis requires clinically significant distress or dysfunction.
B	Absolute language	Many routines are normal; OCD involves distressing, time-consuming obsessions or compulsions.
C	Camouflage	Others' opinions do not decide a diagnosis.
D	Dropped element	Unusualness alone is not enough; distress or impairment is required.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A hiring manager ~~at a 900-person insurance firm~~ describes an applicant as organized, dependable, and careful to meet deadlines. ~~The applicant enjoys hiking and is left-handed.~~ Which Big Five trait fits best?

Target word: Big Five trait **Decides:** Organized, dependable, deadline-focused.

A	Adjacent category	That is a type system, not a Big Five trait.
B	Confusion set	Agreeableness is about warmth and cooperation.
C	Camouflage	Answers the hiking detail, not the described behavior.
D	Correct	Conscientiousness covers organization, dependability, and self-discipline.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A client at a community counseling center ~~that offers evening hours~~ says, "I failed one quiz, so I'm a total failure." The counselor helps him spot the thought, test the evidence for it, and replace it with a more accurate one. ~~The client drives 20 minutes to sessions.~~ Which approach is this?

Target word: therapy approach **Decides:** Identifying and restructuring a distorted thought.

A	Confusion set	Psychodynamic work explores unconscious conflicts and past experiences.
B	Dropped element	Drops the cognitive work, which is the core of this session.
C	Correct	CBT targets and restructures distorted thinking.
D	Adjacent category	Person-centered therapy is non-directive and does not dispute thoughts.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

A therapist offers empathy and unconditional positive regard and lets the client lead each session. Which approach is this?

Target word: reverse: techniques given, name the approach **Decides:** Unconditional positive regard and client-led sessions.

A	Confusion set	CBT is structured and therapist-guided.
B	Adjacent category	Focuses on unconscious conflict and interpretation.
C	Absolute language	Overgeneralizes; the techniques named are humanistic.
D	Correct	These are the hallmarks of person-centered therapy.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Correlation vs. causation	Only an experiment with random assignment supports cause-and-effect claims; correlational data show only a relationship.	Reading a survey link as proof that one thing causes the other.	Surveys or records compared without assigning anyone to conditions.
2	Independent vs. dependent variable	The independent variable is what the researcher changes; the dependent variable is what is measured as the outcome.	Swapping the two, or naming participant traits as the DV.	“Randomly assigned to...” and “then measured...”.
3	Piaget’s stages	Preoperational children (about 2–7) lack conservation and are egocentric; concrete operational children (about 7–11) master conservation.	Placing conservation errors in the sensorimotor stage.	A child says the taller glass has more.
4	Brain structures and functions	Hippocampus forms new long-term memories; amygdala handles fear and emotion; cerebellum coordinates movement; occipital lobe processes vision.	Mixing up the hippocampus and amygdala.	Old memories intact but no new ones form.
5	Reinforcement vs. punishment	Reinforcement increases a behavior and punishment decreases it; positive adds a stimulus and negative removes one.	Calling negative reinforcement punishment.	An unpleasant thing stops when the person acts.
6	What makes a behavior a disorder	Diagnosis requires clinically significant distress or impairment, not just unusual behavior.	Labeling any odd or repetitive habit a disorder.	Life and work are going well despite a quirk.
7	Big Five personality traits	Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism are continuous traits; type systems sort people into categories instead.	Confusing conscientiousness with agreeableness.	Organized, dependable, careful about deadlines.
8	Therapy approaches	CBT restructures distorted thoughts; psychodynamic explores unconscious conflict; humanistic offers empathy and unconditional positive regard.	Calling any structured talk therapy psychodynamic.	Identify the thought, test the evidence, replace it.

Course scope (public description): In this course, students will develop an understanding of psychology and how it helps them better understand others and themselves. Students will learn general theories about psychological development, the structure of the brain, and how psychologists study behavior. They will gain an understanding of both normal and disordered psychological behaviors, as well as general applications of the science of psychology in society (such as personality typing and counseling).